

Meridian Valley General Hospital

Information Technology & Digital Services IT Policies, Systems & Service Desk Handbook

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1. Purpose

This handbook describes the systems supported by the IT & Digital Services department at Meridian Valley General Hospital, along with acceptable use, security, and service request procedures for all staff, providers, and contracted users.

2. Core Systems Supported

System	Purpose	Support Tier
MeridianChart EHR (Epic-based)	Electronic health record, CPOE, eMAR	Tier 1 - Critical
PACS/Radiology Imaging	Diagnostic image storage & viewing	Tier 1 - Critical
Pharmacy Information System	Medication dispensing & tracking	Tier 1 - Critical
Nurse Call & Alarm Integration	Bedside alerting	Tier 1 - Critical
Active Directory / SSO	Network authentication, badge tap login	Tier 1 - Critical
Patient Portal (MyMeridianHealth)	Patient-facing scheduling, results, messaging	Tier 2 - High
Staff Scheduling System (Kronos-like)	Time & attendance, shift scheduling	Tier 2 - High
Office 365 / Email / Teams	Communication & productivity	Tier 3 - Standard

3. Service Desk & Ticketing

The IT Service Desk is reachable 24/7 at ext. 4357 (HELP) or via the self-service portal at itsupport.meridianvalley-demo.org. Tickets are prioritized as follows:

Severity	Definition	Target Response	Target Resolution
Sev 1 - Critical	EHR/CPOE down, network outage affecting patient care	15 min	1 hour
Sev 2 - High	Single critical app down, PACS delay, printer in OPB down	30 min	4 hours
Sev 3 - Medium	Individual workstation issue, non-critical app error	4 hours	1 business day
Sev 4 - Low	Password reset, access request, how-to question	1 business day	3 business days

4. Account Access and Password Policy

- Passwords must be a minimum of 12 characters, including upper/lowercase, a number, and a symbol; expire every 90 days and cannot reuse the last 10 passwords.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is required for all remote access, email, and privileged accounts.
- Accounts lock after 5 failed login attempts; unlock via Service Desk with identity verification.
- Generic/shared logins are prohibited for EHR access; each clinician uses individually issued credentials to preserve the audit trail.
- Access is provisioned based on role (RBAC) and reviewed quarterly by department managers; access is automatically revoked within 24 hours of termination via the HR-IT integration feed.

5. Acceptable Use Policy (Summary)

- Hospital systems and devices are for business use; incidental personal use is permitted if it does not interfere with duties, consume excessive bandwidth, or violate policy.
- Protected Health Information (PHI) may only be accessed on a need-to-know basis; browsing records out of curiosity ("snooping") is a terminable HIPAA violation and is monitored via audit logging.
- USB storage devices are disabled by default on clinical workstations; exceptions require Information Security approval and device encryption.
- Personal cloud storage (e.g., personal Dropbox/Google Drive) may not be used to store hospital data.
- Only IT-approved software may be installed; local admin rights are restricted on clinical devices.

6. Downtime Procedures

In the event of a planned or unplanned EHR downtime, units activate the Downtime Policy (IT-BC-02): downtime paper forms (kept in the red downtime folder on each unit) are used for orders, documentation, and medication administration. Critical results are called directly to the unit. The Downtime Recovery Team reconciles paper documentation into the EHR once systems are restored, with dual sign-off for high-alert medications administered during downtime.

7. Cybersecurity Incident Reporting

Suspected phishing emails, malware, lost/stolen devices, or unauthorized access must be reported immediately to the Security Operations Center at ext. 4911 or security@meridianvalley-demo.org. Do not forward suspected phishing emails to colleagues; use the "Report Phish" button in Outlook. All hospital-issued laptops and mobile devices are encrypted and remote-wipeable.

8. New Hardware / Software Requests

Requests for new hardware, software, or system integrations are submitted via the IT Request Portal and require department director approval. Clinical system changes additionally require review by the Clinical Informatics Governance Committee, which meets on the first Tuesday of each month.

9. Contact

IT & Digital Services, Building B, 3rd Floor | Service Desk: ext. 4357 (24/7) | Security Operations Center: ext. 4911 | Email: itsupport@meridianvalley-demo.org